Crime Analytics Dashboard

Written Summary

Purpose

- A self-serve dashboard for police force leadership to monitor recorded crime, compare forces fairly and see where to focus.
- Two pages: an Overview comparing all four forces, and a Force Deep Dive for one force and its seasonal pattern.

Intended audience

- Senior officers, crime analysis leads and resource planners.
- Designed for a time-poor, non-technical reader to understand at a glance.

Key assumptions and limitations

- Four forces (West Midlands, Nottinghamshire, Staffordshire and Essex), by month, from July 2023 to May 2026.
- 2023 and 2026 are partial years, so read seasonal patterns from the full years 2024 and 2025.
- Crime rates are per 1,000 residents, so forces should be compared on rate, not on raw counts.
- Population data runs to 2024 and is carried forward for later months, so recent rates are approximate.
- Deprivation is shown as an average IMD decile, where a lower number means more deprived. It is context for reading the figures, not a cause of crime.
- Figures reflect recorded crime and where forces focus attention, not total offending.
- Geographic hotspot mapping is out of scope, as the data is aggregated to force level rather than smaller areas.